

Executive Overview: All 6 critical technical SEO and functional items reported by the client have been completely investigated, resolved, verified across environments, and deployed to production. This report provides a transparent audit of each issue, the root cause, the exact source files modified, and step-by-step instructions to verify each item on both the production custom domain (ashali.com) and the Vercel staging deployment.

1. 301 Permanent Redirects for Legacy URLs

RESOLVED

ISSUE: Google still held legacy indexed URLs from WordPress/Vite (`/home` , `/home-booked` , `/consulting` , `/testimonials` , `/contact-us` , `/change-your-life` , `/book` , `/workshop` , `/unlock` , and old blog posts like `/just-eat-gets-10-5-million-in-vc-investment`). When visitors or crawlers requested these URLs, they encountered 404 errors, causing severe ranking drops and traffic leakage.

SOURCE FILE: `frontend-next/next.config.ts`

FIX APPLIED: Implemented permanent HTTP 301 redirects in the Next.js server configuration mapping each legacy URL to its modern destination: `/consulting` → `/advisory` , `/testimonials` → `/speaking` , `/contact-us` → `/contact` , `/home` & `/home-booked` → `/` , `/change-your-life` → `/` , `/just-eat-gets-10-5-million-in-vc-investment` → `/portfolio/just-eat` , `/book` → `/unfair-advantage` , `/workshop` → `/workshops` , and `/unlock` → `/the-next-level` .

How to Verify: Visit www.ashali.com/consulting (or ash-ali-nextjs.vercel.app/consulting) • The server immediately responds with HTTP 308/301 and seamlessly forwards the browser to `/advisory` . Test [/testimonials](http://www.ashali.com/testimonials) (forwards to `/speaking`) and [/contact-us](http://www.ashali.com/contact-us) (forwards to `/contact`).

2. Soft 404 Elimination & Genuine HTTP 404 Status Codes

RESOLVED

ISSUE: In the previous build, missing or mistyped URLs returned an HTTP 200 (Success) status code with an empty client shell ("Soft 404"). Google Search Console penalizes sites with Soft 404s because Google treats empty pages as thin content instead of recognizing they do not exist.

SOURCE FILE: `frontend-next/src/app/not-found.tsx`

FIX APPLIED: Resolved legacy routes via proper redirects and configured Next.js standard `not-found.tsx` . Unknown routes now strictly emit a genuine HTTP 404 status code with a custom-designed, branded "Page Not Found" layout, prompting Google to properly purge invalid URLs from search indexes.

How to Verify: Open network developer tools or run curl against any invalid URL like www.ashali.com/page-not-found-test • Confirm the HTTP status code returned in the headers is strictly `404 Not Found` .

3. Dynamic XML Sitemap & Search Engine Crawler File

RESOLVED

ISSUE: Google Search Console was only indexing the homepage because the website lacked an XML sitemap and a `robots.txt` file instructing search engines on how to discover and index sub-pages.

SOURCE FILES: `frontend-next/src/app/sitemap.ts` • `frontend-next/src/app/robots.ts`

FIX APPLIED: Created an automated dynamic XML sitemap generating valid entries for all 41 pages (core pages, workshops, book editions, portfolio case studies, and updates) with appropriate change frequencies and SEO priority weights. Configured `robots.txt` allowing search engine indexing and referencing the full sitemap index.

How to Verify: View the live sitemap at www.ashali.com/sitemap.xml and the crawler file at www.ashali.com/robots.txt. In Google Search Console, submit <https://www.ashali.com/sitemap.xml> under *Sitemaps* to immediately request rapid indexing.

4. Per-Page Dedicated Social Cards (OG Images) & Custom Meta Descriptions

RESOLVED

- ISSUE:** Every page shared a single generic card (`/og/default.png`) and the homepage description when shared on LinkedIn, WhatsApp, Facebook, or Twitter. Sharing an advisory or keynote page gave no contextual preview.
- SOURCE FILES:** `frontend-next/public/og/*.png` • Metadata exports across `frontend-next/src/app/*/page.tsx`
- FIX APPLIED:** Generated 9 high-resolution (1200x630) custom OpenGraph cards featuring tailored typography, section tags, and Ash Ali's portrait cutout (`about.png` , `speaking.png` , `workshops.png` , `advisory.png` , `unfair-advantage.png` , `the-next-level.png` , `impact.png` , `contact.png` , `portfolio.png`). Injected distinct SEO titles and compelling meta descriptions into every page metadata configuration.

How to Verify: Inspect individual OG cards directly: [/og/speaking.png](#), [/og/advisory.png](#), [/og/workshops.png](#). Paste any page link into LinkedIn Post Inspector or WhatsApp to confirm the dedicated preview card renders.

5. Contact Form Visibility, Contrast & Rendering Fix

RESOLVED

- ISSUE:** Client reported: "On Friday only enquiry type and in-person/virtual toggles were visible." The previous build had transparent input fields with no boundary borders on a pitch-black background, combined with an animation opacity delay that failed to trigger on some devices. All 9 text inputs and the date picker were rendered invisibly, making the form look completely empty.
- SOURCE FILE:** `frontend-next/src/Components/Pages/Contact/ContactSection.tsx`
- FIX APPLIED:** Refactored all form inputs with elevated, distinct backgrounds (`#1a1a1a`), crisp boundary borders (`border-white/10` , brightening to `border-white/50` on focus), and high-contrast placeholders (`placeholder-gray-400`). Removed the scroll animation opacity lag so all 9 fields (Name, Email, Organisation, Event Name, Date Picker, Location, Audience Size, Topic, Budget, and Message) render instantly on page load.

How to Verify: Visit www.ashali.com/contact • Notice that all fields, date pickers, calendar flyouts, and the message textarea are clearly delineated with visible borders, responsive hover/focus states, and crisp text contrast across all devices.

6. Uhubs 2026 Capability Index Report Direct Download Flow

RESOLVED

- ISSUE:** The "Download the full report →" button previously had no download functionality or backend lead integration. Clicking it merely showed a generic dark modal with mock text. Furthermore, opening cross-origin CDN URLs in new tabs caused browser pop-up blocks and exposed third-party Webflow CDN addresses.
- SOURCE FILES:** `frontend-next/src/Components/Pages/Home/CapabilityIndexSection.tsx` • `frontend-next/next.config.ts` • `frontend-next/public/reports/Global-Sales-Capability-Index-2026-Uhubs.pdf`
- FIX APPLIED:**
- Local Hosting:** The complete official 40-page Uhubs report PDF (8.5 MB) is hosted locally on the site under `/reports/Global-Sales-Capability-Index-2026-Uhubs.pdf` , eliminating external CDN links.
 - Direct Attachment Headers:** Configured `Content-Disposition: attachment` headers in `next.config.ts` so clicking download instantly saves the file to the user's computer without opening a new tab or navigating away.
 - Lead Submission Flow:** Submitting the form posts lead details to the backend API and cleanly transitions to the official Uhubs success popup design (cream background, rounded corners, centered title, dark pill button). It does *not* prematurely trigger downloads on form submit.
 - Download Now Button:** The user clicks the prominent **Download Now** pill button in the popup, which triggers the instant direct file download.

How to Verify: Visit www.ashali.com • Scroll to the Uhubs section • Click "Download the full report →" • Submit your details • Confirm the modal switches to the official Uhubs cream popup • Click "Download Now" • The 8.5 MB PDF downloads immediately to your computer with zero new tabs opened.